Porter-Style Delivery Platform: Business Model Canvas and Unit Economics

Document 3 of the pack | Version 0.3 (draft, Zoom2u benchmark prices, carrying confirmed) | Market: Melbourne, Victoria
IMPORTANT: Customer prices in this version come from real Zoom2u quotes collected for seven test jobs (Section 3). Cost items (card fee, insurance, support, vehicle running cost, monthly running cost, acquisition cost) are still illustrative placeholders and are marked as such. Quotes from other competitors are deferred until after the app is built.
Labels: FACT, ASSUMPTION, RISK, OPPORTUNITY, RECOMMENDATION, OPEN QUESTION.

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1. Business Model Canvas

Block	Current draft
Customer segments	Open to all. Launch focus: consumers with bulky-item jobs (Marketplace pickups, small moves) plus a handful of anchor SMBs (furniture stores, florists)
Value proposition	Instant, fixed, all-in price for a specific job; right-sized vehicle; tracked job with photo proof of delivery; no phone calls or negotiating
Channels	Mobile app and web booking; local social and Marketplace communities; partnerships with SMBs and sellers; referrals
Customer relationships	Self-serve booking; in-app support; personal handling of anchor SMBs
Revenue streams	Commission on each job (primary). Later: business subscriptions, add-on fees, priority booking
Key resources	Booking and matching platform; verified independent driver pool; payments setup; insurance arrangements; brand and trust
Key activities	Driver verification and onboarding; matching and dispatch; pricing engine; dispute and damage handling; local marketing
Key partners	Insurer or broker; payments provider; mapping provider; anchor SMBs; legal adviser
Cost structure	Driver payouts (pass-through), payment fees, insurance, support, technology build and hosting, marketing, incentives for early supply, legal and compliance

2. How the money flows

1. The customer pays the all-in job price at booking.
2. The platform keeps a commission and passes the rest to the driver.
3. The platform pays card fees, insurance, support and refunds from its commission.
4. What remains is contribution per job, which must cover technology, team, marketing and incentives.

ASSUMPTION: The platform sets the price (as Uber does), rather than drivers bidding. This supports the fixed-price positioning but increases legal and pricing responsibility. OPEN QUESTION: confirm this model.

3. Benchmark data: Zoom2u quotes (collected by you, Oct 2026)

#	Job (route)	Same day	Within 3 hours	Within 1 hour	3h premium	1h premium
1	Parcel: Flinders St to Richmond	$28	$34	$52	+21%	+86%
2	Box: Footscray to Flinders St	$32	$40	$66	+25%	+106%
3	Couch: Richmond to Footscray	$41	$51	$88	+24%	+115%
4	Couch, stairs: Richmond to Footscray	$51	$61	$99	+20%	+94%
5	Appliance: Footscray to Richmond	$41	$51	$89	+24%	+117%
6	Longer distance: Footscray to Box Hill	$66	$80	$161	+21%	+144%
7	Small move	$130 per hour	n/a	n/a	n/a	n/a

Jobs 1 and 2 were quoted for same day by 5pm and by 8:30pm at the same price.

FACT (from the quotes):

- Speed is priced hard. Within one hour costs roughly 1.9x to 2.4x the same-day price. Within three hours adds about 20% to 25%.
- A wide time window costs nothing extra. Same day by 5pm and by 8:30pm were the same price.
- Stairs add about $10 ($11 in the one-hour tier).
- Item weight doesn't seem to change the price. The couch (job 3) and washing machine (job 5) were within $1 of each other on reversed routes. Vehicle and distance appear to drive price.
- Distance matters. The Box Hill job is about 60% above the Richmond to Footscray job at same-day, and about 83% above at one hour.

Not yet known (affects every number below):

1. Which vehicle was selected for jobs 3 to 6?
2. Carrying: you've confirmed that standard practice is for the driver to carry and the customer not to help, so the quotes are assumed to include driver carrying. A second person is an add-on. The add-on price is not yet known (the $35 in the very first draft was a placeholder, not a market figure).
3. Are prices GST-inclusive?
4. Job 7: is $130 per hour for the van plus two movers, and is there a minimum number of hours?

ASSUMPTION (working price): For now, Porter's customer price equals Zoom2u's same-day price, with urgency tiers and the stairs add-on mirroring theirs. Job 7 is treated as $130 per hour for 2 hours (260), which is a guess. RISK: This rests on one competitor. Airtasker, GoPeople, Sherpa and van operators are not yet compared, so the "fixed price beats quote-and-negotiate" idea stays untested.

4. Job economics at working prices

Commission 20%. Card fee assumed at 2% plus 30 cents (unverified). Insurance reserve and support costs are placeholders carried over from the earlier version (bike: $0.40 / $0.50; car: $0.80 / $0.80; van: $2.00 / $1.50; van with helpers: $4.00 / $3.00).

#	Job (same-day price)	Commission	Card fee	Insurance	Support	Contribution	% of price
1	Parcel, $28	$5.60	$0.86	$0.40	$0.50	$3.84	13.7%
2	Box, $32	$6.40	$0.94	$0.80	$0.80	$3.86	12.1%
3	Couch, $41	$8.20	$1.12	$2.00	$1.50	$3.58	8.7%
4	Couch with stairs, $51	$10.20	$1.32	$2.00	$1.50	$5.38	10.5%
5	Appliance, $41	$8.20	$1.12	$2.00	$1.50	$3.58	8.7%
6	Longer distance, $66	$13.20	$1.62	$2.00	$1.50	$8.08	12.2%
7	Small move, $260 (2 hours assumed)	$52.00	$5.50	$4.00	$3.00	$39.50	15.2%

The core job (3) across urgency tiers:

Tier	Price	Commission	Contribution	Driver receives
Same day	$41	$8.20	$3.58	$32.80
Within 3 hours	$51	$10.20	$5.38	$40.80
Within 1 hour	$88	$17.60	$12.04	$70.40

Driver earnings check (placeholders: vehicle cost $0.50 per km). The 1.25 hours includes the driver loading and unloading:

Job	Driver receives	Time	Vehicle cost	Net per hour
3, same day	$32.80	1.25 hours, 20 km	$10.00	$18.24
3, within 3 hours	$40.80	1.25 hours, 20 km	$10.00	$24.64

3, within 1 hour	$70.40	1.25 hours, 20 km	$10.00	$48.32
6, same day	$52.80	1.75 hours, 35 km	$17.50	$20.17

FACT (context): The Fair Work Commission safety-net rate for food and grocery delivery is $31.30 per hour (Fair Work Ombudsman). It does not currently apply to this work, but it is a useful fairness reference.

What the Zoom2u data changes:

- The core job is priced about 41% below the earlier placeholder ($41 vs $70). At a 20% commission, the platform keeps only about $3.58 on a same-day couch job.
- A same-day couch job at this price pays the driver poorly. Net earnings are about $18 per hour in this model, well under the $31.30 reference. Even with zero commission the driver would net only about $24.80 per hour. RISK: Matching same-day pricing leaves no room for both a fair driver wage and platform margin on a standalone job. It would only work if jobs are faster than assumed or batched into routes. How Zoom2u pays its own drivers is unknown.
- Urgency is where the money is. The one-hour tier gives $12.04 contribution and about $48 per hour to the driver. RISK: Fast jobs need drivers close by and waiting, which is hardest to achieve early on.
- Longer trips and small moves pay better than short single-item runs, in this model.
- RECOMMENDATION: Test pricing with a flexible-window rate (cheap, batched) and a clearly priced urgent rate, and avoid launching on same-day single couch moves alone.

5. Commission sensitivity (core job 3, same-day $41)

Direct costs held at $4.62 (card fee $1.12, insurance $2.00, support $1.50).

Commission	Platform keeps	Contribution	Driver receives
15%	$6.15	$1.53	$34.85
20%	$8.20	$3.58	$32.80
25%	$10.25	$5.63	$30.75
30%	$12.30	$7.68	$28.70

Analysis: Each extra 5 points of commission adds about $2.05 to the platform and removes the same from the driver. There is little room to raise commission without making the driver's pay worse than it already looks. Competitor take rates are not known (OPEN QUESTION).

6. Break-even and acquisition checks (placeholders)

ASSUMPTION: Lean pilot running costs of $40,000 per month (technology, a small team, marketing, legal).

Core job tier	Contribution	Jobs per month to break even	About per day
Same day ($41)	$3.58	about 11,170	370

Within 3 hours ($51)	$5.38	about 7,430	250
Within 1 hour ($88)	$12.04	about 3,320	110

Customer acquisition vs lifetime value:

- ASSUMPTION: Consumer acquisition cost of $25, and two jobs per customer in the first year.
- First-year contribution per consumer at same-day pricing: 2 x $3.58 = $7.16. At the 3-hour tier: $10.76. Both are well below $25.

RISK: On these figures consumers do not repay their acquisition cost in a year. This strengthens the case for the anchor-SMB track, for repeat-use customers, and for referral and organic channels.

7. What would improve the economics

Lever	Effect	Trade-off
Higher average job value (add-ons: helper, stairs, disposal)	More contribution per booking	Complexity, more insurance exposure
Repeat-use customers (SMBs, frequent sellers)	Lowers effective acquisition cost	Slower to win
Fee on the customer side (service fee)	Raises contribution without cutting driver pay	Raises the customer's visible price
Business subscriptions	Predictable revenue	Needs a business customer base first
Cheaper insurance through better risk controls (photos, item rules)	Higher margin	Needs insurer negotiation
Referral and organic channels	Lower acquisition cost	Slower growth

8. Key unknowns to replace with data

1. Quotes from other competitors (GoPeople, Sherpa, Airtasker, a van operator); deferred until after the app is built
2. Actual card fees and insurance cost per job
3. Realistic jobs per driver per hour in the launch corridor
4. Repeat rate by customer type
5. Whether customers accept a service fee on top of the job price
6. Legal treatment of driver pay if a future minimum standards order covers last-mile goods delivery

9. Next steps

1. Confirm the open details on the Zoom2u quotes (vehicle, helper included, GST) listed in Section 3.
2. Get quotes for goods-in-transit and public liability insurance.
3. Decide the pricing model (platform-set fixed price) and commission range to test.
4. Move to Document 4: MVP Definition and Risk Register.
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